DOH-NCIP-DILG JOINT MEMORANDUM CIRCULAR NO. 2015-01
02 December 2015

FOR	:	**All NCIP, DOH and DILG Units, Levels and Attached Agencies, Local Government Units, Indigenous Cultural Communities/Indigenous Peoples, and All Concerned, Private and Civil Organizations**
SUBJECT	:	**Creation of Inter-Agency Committees on Indigenous Peoples' Health**

I. Rational

In pursuit of Universal Health Care/Kalusugan Pangkalahatan especially among the disadvantaged groups, the Department of Health (DOH), National Commission on Indigenous People (NCIP) and Department of Interior and Local Government (DILG) issued the Joint Memorandum Circular No. 2013-01 dated 19 April 2013, *"Guidelines on the Delivery of Basic Health Services for Indigenous Cultural Communities/Indigenous Peoples (ICCs/IPs)"*. The Circular aims to set the guidelines that will address access, utilization, coverage, and equity issues in the provision of basic health services for ICCs/IPs to achieve better health outcomes.

Pursuant to the JMC, the NCIP, DOH and DILG will be the main implementing agencies and shall oversee the implementation and monitoring activities within the JMC and its strategic plan. An inter-agency committee at the national, regional and provincial levels shall be organized to oversee the planning, implementation, and monitoring & evaluation of the guidelines set within the JMC.

II. Creation and Composition. An Inter-Agency Committee on IP Health (hereinafter referred to as the Committee) is hereby created to carry out the implementation arrangements of the JMC, to be composed of representatives from the following:

A. National:

Chairperson	:	National Commission on Indigenous Peoples (NCIP)
Vice-Chairperson	:	Department of Health (DOH)
Members	:	Department Of Interior and Local Government (DILG)
		Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD)
		Department of Education (DepEd)
		National Anti-Poverty Commission (NAPC)
		Philippine Health Insurance Corporation (PHIC)
		Philippine Institute for Traditional Alternative Health Care (PITAHC)

B. Regional:

Chairperson	:	Department of Health (DOH)
Co-Chairperson		National Commission on Indigenous Peoples (NCIP)
Members	:	Department Of Interior and Local Government (DILG)
		Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD)
		Department of Education (DepEd)
		Philippine Health Insurance Corporation (PHIC)

C. Provincial:

Chairperson	:	Provincial Health Office (PHO)
Co-Chairperson		Department Of Interior and Local Government (DILG)
Members	:	National Commission on Indigenous Peoples (NCIP)
		Department of Health (DOH)
		Department of Social Welfare and Development (DSWD)
		Department of Education (DepEd)

The Technical Working Group (TWG) of each level shall provide secretariat support to the Committee. The TWG composition shall be determined by the Committee members in each level.

The Committee may call upon or invite representatives from any department, bureau, office, agency or instrumentality of the government, and request the local government units, private sector and non-government organizations for assistance as the circumstances may require.

III. Functions. The Committees and the Technical Working Group (TWG) shall have the following functions:

A. National:

1. Oversee and ensure the overall implementation of the commitments under the Joint Memorandum Circular (JMC) # 2013-01 dated 19 April 2013 and its strategic and operation plan;
2. Determine all necessary policy and other interventions to ensure the successful implementation of their commitments under the JMC; and
3. Review and resolves issues and concerns relative to the implementation of the JMC commitments.

B. Regional:

1. Serve as the technical coordinating and monitoring arm in the implementation of the JMC and its strategic plan at the regional level;
2. Coordinate all technical concerns/requirements with various concerned government agencies and non-government sectors to facilitate and ensure effective implementation of the JMC at the regional level and ensure complementation and synchronization of commitments;
3. Provide technical assistance to regional and local counterparts;
4. Advocate to other stakeholders;
5. Monitor the implementation of all plans, programs, and projects at the regional level; and
6. Provide regular feedback/status report on progress of the implementation, and policy recommendations to the NIAC.

C. Provincial

1. Serve as the technical coordinating and monitoring arm in the implementation of the JMC and its strategic plan at the provincial level;
2. Coordinate all technical concerns/requirements with various concerned government agencies and non-government sectors to facilitate and ensure effective implementation of the JMC at the province and municipal levels and ensure complementation and synchronization of commitments;
3. Provide technical assistance to province and local counterparts
4. Advocate to other local stakeholders
5. Monitor the implementation of all plans, programs, and projects at the province and municipal levels;
6. Provide regular feedback/status report on progress of the implementation, and policy recommendations to the RIAC.

D. <u>Technical Working Group:</u>

1. Gather and evaluate information on the JMC implementation from the national, regional and provincial inter-agency committees;
2. Plan, coordinate and implement strategies and activities at each level as laid out in the IP Health Strategic Plan;
3. Facilitate provision of capacity building interventions and technical assistance to regional, provincial and local counterparts;
4. Conduct consultations on the JMC implementation arrangements and other concerns on IP Health;
5. Coordinate with their regional, provincial and local counterparts in ensuring that their respective commitments are implemented.

IV. Funding. The member-agencies of the Committee shall charge against their current appropriations such amounts as may be necessary for the implementation of this Circular, subject to the budgetary, accounting and auditing rules and regulations. Additional funds and possible sources as may be necessary for the implementation of the JMC and its strategic plan shall be identified and provided by member-agencies.

V. Effectivity. This Circular shall take effect immediately.

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